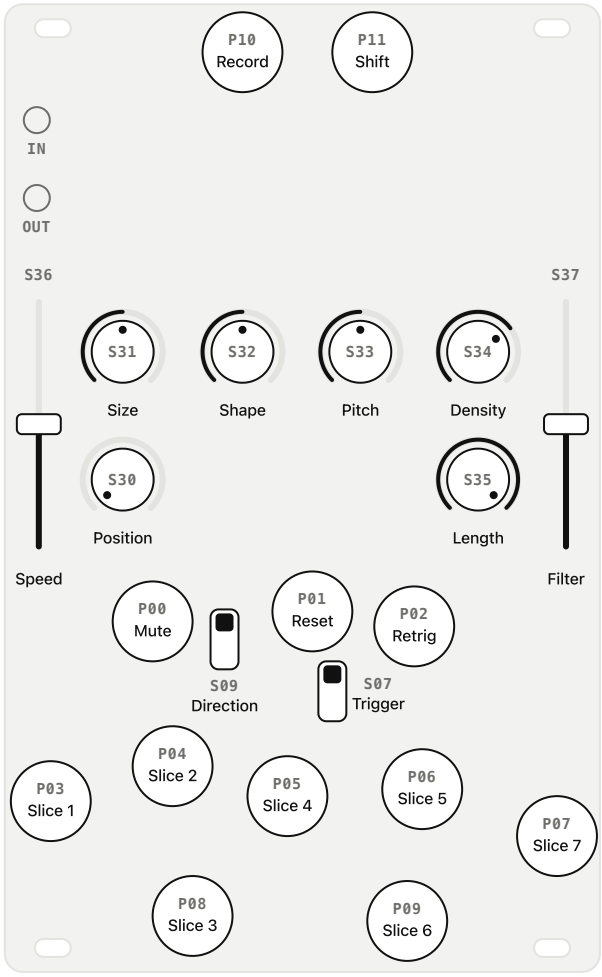
Simple Touch

Clessidra

It's the instrument where you pour grains of sound from single drops into a dense cloud.

francescodimaggio.nl/clessidra

Synthux Design Residency 2026



Two layers: own, and P11 (Shift) held for each knob's randomness and the reverb.

Pick-up: a knob takes over a value once it reaches it.

Randomness: off at the centre, up even, down a long tail.

LAYERS

CONTROL	OWN	P11 SHIFT
S36	Speed	–
S37	Filter	Reverb
S30	Position	Position Random
S35	Length	Length Random
S31	Size	Size Random
S32	Shape	Shape Random
S33	Pitch	Pitch Random
S34	Density	Density Random

FADERS AND KNOBS

S36	Playhead speed, 0 to 4×, 1× at the centre. Frozen: moves the point.
S37	Low-pass down, 20 kHz to 200 Hz. Off at the centre. High-pass up, to 2 kHz.
P11 + S37	Reverb on the grains. Amount and decay, 0.5 to 16 s.
S30	Selection start, anywhere in the recording.
P11 + S30	Position randomness per grain. Off at the centre, up even, down a long tail.
S35	Selection length, past the end round to the start. All at the top.
P11 + S35	Length randomness per pass. Off at the centre, up even, down a long tail.
S31	Grain size, 10 ms, 200 ms at the centre, up to half the recording, 4 s at most.
P11 + S31	Size randomness per grain. Off at the centre, up even, down a long tail.
S32	Grain window: reverse percussive, Hann at the centre, percussive.
P11 + S32	Shape randomness per grain. Off at the centre, up even, down a long tail.
S33	±24 semitones. Stops at 0, 0.1, 5, 7, 12, 17, 19, 24.
P11 + S33	Pitch randomness per grain. Off at the centre, up even, down a long tail.
S34	Grains per second. None at the bottom, then 0.3 to 131, exponential.
P11 + S34	Density randomness of the starts. Off at the centre, up even, down a long tail.

PADS AND SWITCHES

P10	Tap: the last seconds, as set. Hold: up to 30 s. With Shift: listen, firmer for more.
P11	Held, or tapped to latch: the randomness, S37 the reverb. Esc unlatches.
P02	Playhead to the selection start.
P03–P09	Plays its slice with its own grains, as Trigger sets. Pressure sets density.
S09	Up forward, centre freeze, down reverse. Frozen, S36 moves the point.
S07	Slice pads: up once to the end, centre while held, down looped while held.

LED

Glow	Grains playing
Flashing	Recording
Pulse	At a centre: pitch unison, speed 1×, size 200 ms
Steady	P11 held: the value of the knob last turned